

Warehouse Safety Procedure

Document reference WSP-2024-03. This procedure applies to all staff, contractors and visitors entering the distribution centre. It supersedes all previous versions and must be reviewed annually by the site safety officer.

1. Scope

This procedure covers the goods-in bay, the racking aisles, the cold storage area and the loading dock. It does not cover the office block, which is governed by the general workplace policy.

2. Responsibilities

Shift supervisors are responsible for confirming that every person on the floor has completed induction training before the shift begins. Any person without a valid induction record must be escorted from the operational area.

3. General personal protective equipment

High-visibility vests must be worn at all times in the racking aisles and the loading dock. Steel toe-capped boots are mandatory anywhere pallets are moved. Bump caps are required beneath racking that is under two metres in clearance.

Hearing protection is required within ten metres of the baling compactor while it is running. The compactor operator must confirm the area is clear before starting a cycle.

4. Forklift operation

Only staff holding a current counterbalance licence may operate a forklift. The maximum speed inside the building is 8 km/h. Pedestrians always have right of way, and a forklift must come to a complete stop when a pedestrian is within three metres.

5. Cold storage area

The cold storage area operates at minus 18 degrees Celsius. Required PPE in the cold storage area is an insulated freezer jacket, insulated gloves, thermal trousers and non-slip boots rated for sub-zero surfaces. A high-visibility vest must be worn over the freezer jacket.

No person may work alone inside cold storage. Continuous time inside the area is limited to 45 minutes, followed by a minimum 15 minute warming break. The door release must be tested at the start of every shift.

6. Manual handling

The single-person lift limit is 23 kilograms. Loads above that limit require a two-person lift or a pallet truck. Staff must not climb racking to retrieve stock under any circumstances.

7. Incident reporting

All incidents, including near misses, must be reported to the shift supervisor before the end of the shift in which they occurred. The supervisor records the incident in the site log within 24 hours.

Any injury requiring more than first aid must additionally be reported to the site safety officer within one working day, and the affected area must be isolated until it has been inspected.

8. Review

This procedure is reviewed every twelve months, or immediately following any reportable incident. The current version is held by the site safety officer.